

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

India, China, Major Powers and Resilient Supply Chains - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

India, China, Major Powers and Resilient Supply Chains	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
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03 FOUNDATION — DE-RISKING AGAINST DECOUPLING AND THE FRIEND-SHORING LOGIC De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or	04 CORE — THE UNITED STATES TRACK AS TACTICAL CONVERGENCE WITH UNRESOLVED Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier
05 CORE — THE CRITICAL AND EMERGING TECHNOLOGY INITIATIVE AND ITS EXACT Evidence chain: The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology	06 CORE — CLEAN-ENERGY COMMITMENTS AND THE TRUST, COMPACT AND MISSION 500 Evidence chain: Clean-energy supply-chain commitments of
07 CORE — THE TEN-YEAR DEFENCE FRAMEWORK AND THE ENABLING-AGREEMENT Evidence chain: The ten-year defence framework of October 2025 and	08 CORE — RUSSIA AS DEFENCE-ENERGY COMPLEMENTARITY Evidence chain: Russia as defence-energy complementarity rather
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Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. B. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and

2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. B. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands

from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. D. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The India-China economic-strategic paradox?

A. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. B. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw

materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Answer: A. Explanation: In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under The India-China economic-strategic paradox in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. The remaining options belong to different actors,

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The India-China economic-strategic paradox?

A. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. D. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier.

Answer: C. Explanation: In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The India-China economic-strategic paradox?

A. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal

character and India's obligations. D. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement.

Answer: D. Explanation: In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Trade-pattern asymmetry as an economic grievance layered on strategic mistrust?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under Trade-pattern asymmetry as an economic grievance layered on strategic mistrust in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. B. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. C. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. D. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Trade-pattern asymmetry as an economic grievance layered on strategic mistrust?

A. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and

wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Trade-pattern asymmetry as an economic grievance layered on strategic mistrust?

A. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. D. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies De-risking against decoupling?

A. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. D. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.

Answer: A. Explanation: De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under De-risking against decoupling in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. B. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. C. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its

evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: B. Explanation: De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of De-risking against decoupling?

A. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. B. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: C. Explanation: De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about De-risking against decoupling?

A. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. B. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a

treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. C. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. D. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.

Answer: D. Explanation: De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Friend-shoring and trusted supply chains as the Western policy logic?

A. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: A. Explanation: Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Q18. Which card should be filed under Friend-shoring and trusted supply chains as the Western policy logic in an International Relations answer?

A. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. D. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available.

Answer: B. Explanation: Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Friend-shoring and trusted supply chains as the Western policy logic?

A. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. B. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. C. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it

as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. D. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession.

Answer: C. Explanation: Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Friend-shoring and trusted supply chains as the Western policy logic?

A. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. B. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. C. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. D. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Answer: D. Explanation: Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The United States track as technology-led tactical convergence?

A. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under The United States track as technology-led tactical convergence in an International Relations answer?

A. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. B. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. C. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial

cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The United States track as technology-led tactical convergence?

A. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. B. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. C. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. D. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The United States track as technology-led tactical convergence?

A. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. B. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of

geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. C. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. D. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Technology-access asymmetry as unresolved friction?

A. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. B. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. C. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. D. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under Technology-access asymmetry as unresolved friction in an International Relations answer?

A. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. B. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. C. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. D. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Technology-access asymmetry as unresolved friction?

A. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. B. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. C. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. D. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and

the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Technology-access asymmetry as unresolved friction?

A. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. B. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. C. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. D. Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its exact status?

A. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. B. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. C. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. D. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available.

Answer: A. Explanation: The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its exact status in an International Relations answer?

A. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. B. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. C. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. D. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership,

Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession.

Answer: B. Explanation: The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its exact status?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. C. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. D. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its exact status?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Answer: D. Explanation: The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Clean-energy supply-chain commitments of September 2024?

A. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. B. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. C. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an

automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. D. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.

Answer: A. Explanation: India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under Clean-energy supply-chain commitments of September 2024 in an International Relations answer?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. C. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. D. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery.

Answer: B. Explanation: India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Clean-energy supply-chain commitments of September 2024?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. C. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. D. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery.

Answer: C. Explanation: India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Clean-energy supply-chain commitments of September 2024?

A. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. B. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. C. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy

complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. D. India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available.

Answer: D. Explanation: India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies TRUST, COMPACT and Mission 500 of February 2025?

A. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. B. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. C. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. D. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under TRUST, COMPACT and Mission 500 of February 2025 in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. B. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. C. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. D. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of TRUST, COMPACT and Mission 500 of February 2025?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. C. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for

critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. D. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about TRUST, COMPACT and Mission 500 of February 2025?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic

Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The ten-year defence framework of October 2025 and its non-treaty character?

A. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. B. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under The ten-year defence framework of October 2025 and its non-treaty character in an International Relations answer?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated

India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. C. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. D. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The ten-year defence framework of October 2025 and its non-treaty character?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. C. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a

framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The ten-year defence framework of October 2025 and its non-treaty character?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Dopsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. C. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. D. The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The enabling-agreement architecture and what it does not create?

A. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. B. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. C. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. D. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under The enabling-agreement architecture and what it does not create in an International Relations answer?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production

milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The enabling-agreement architecture and what it does not create?

A. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. B. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. C. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and

coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The enabling-agreement architecture and what it does not create?

A. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. B. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. C. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. D. The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation

directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Russia as defence-energy complementarity rather than one-sided dependence?

A. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. B. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under Russia as defence-energy complementarity rather than one-sided dependence in an International Relations answer?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere,

including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. C. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Russia as defence-energy complementarity rather than one-sided dependence?

A. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower

installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Russia as defence-energy complementarity rather than one-sided dependence?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign

military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The Russian installed base, joint production and third-party sanctions exposure?

A. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. B. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. C. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under The Russian installed base, joint production and third-party sanctions exposure in an International Relations answer?

A. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. B. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Russian installed base, joint production and third-party sanctions exposure?

A. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. D. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

Answer: C. Explanation: Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Russian installed base, joint production and third-party sanctions exposure?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for

dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India.

Answer: D. Explanation: Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit of December 2025?

A. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics

access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: A. Explanation: The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit of December 2025 in an International Relations answer?

A. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. B. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment,

that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

Answer: B. Explanation: The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit of December 2025?

A. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. D. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

Answer: C. Explanation: The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit of December 2025?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. C. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. D. The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority.

Answer: D. Explanation: The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The India-China border and dialogue architecture as process, not settlement?

A. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. B. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: A. Explanation: On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under The India-China border and dialogue architecture as process, not settlement in an International Relations answer?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The India-China border and dialogue architecture as process, not settlement?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. C. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. D. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The India-China border and dialogue architecture as process, not settlement?

A. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies The United States tariff cycle of 2025-26 as an architecture stress test?

A. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. D. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q66. Which card should be filed under The United States tariff cycle of 2025-26 as an architecture stress test in an International Relations answer?

A. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. B. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

Answer: B. Explanation: An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The United States tariff cycle of 2025-26 as an architecture stress test?

A. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. B. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. C. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. D. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The United States tariff cycle of 2025-26 as an architecture stress test?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Answer: D. Explanation: An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The Japan pillar as a non-treaty security, infrastructure and technology partner?

A. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. B. The European Union-India Trade

and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. C. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. D. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under The Japan pillar as a non-treaty security, infrastructure and technology partner in an International Relations answer?

A. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. B. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and

technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. C. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. D. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Japan pillar as a non-treaty security, infrastructure and technology partner?

A. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. B. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. C. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and

Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. D. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Japan pillar as a non-treaty security, infrastructure and technology partner?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The European Union pillar and the not-yet-in-force qualification?

A. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. B. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement.

Answer: A. Explanation: The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. The remaining options

Q74. Which card should be filed under The European Union pillar and the not-yet-in-force qualification in an International Relations answer?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. C. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. D. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The European Union pillar and the not-yet-in-force qualification?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on

27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. D. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.

Answer: C. Explanation: The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The European Union pillar and the not-yet-in-force qualification?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

Answer: D. Explanation: The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The Ukraine posture, minilateral balancing and honest question ownership?

A. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. B. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12.

Answer: A. Explanation: Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under The Ukraine posture, minilateral balancing and honest question ownership in an International Relations answer?

A. In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. B. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. C. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. D. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.

Answer: B. Explanation: Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Ukraine posture, minilateral balancing and honest question ownership?

A. Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. B. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. C. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. D. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.

Answer: C. Explanation: Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Ukraine posture, minilateral balancing and honest question ownership?

A. Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. B. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. C. De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. D. Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Four General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledger records them: 2019 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership, a Comment demand of 10 marks and 150 words; 2019 General Studies Paper II question 20 on friction in India-United States ties and India's place in United States global strategy, an Explain with suitable examples demand of 15 marks and 250 words; 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 on the United States facing an existential challenge from China, an Explain demand of 10 marks and 150 words; and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the West fostering India as an alternative to China's supply chain, an Explain demand of 10 marks and 150 words. For the three 2019 and 2021 demands the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership and that the word limits are taken from the instruction block. Two objective demands are also routed to this owner and are carried as coverage requirements only: 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan, for which the official key is not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally. No option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand, and the provisional status of the 2026 key is preserved exactly. The supplied paper text of the 2024 demand carries apparent grammatical and spelling defects, and the owners require that it be reproduced as printed rather than silently corrected, which is done in the corresponding demand card below. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or page precision was imported. Every model solution below is original work written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern, and none of them reproduces or claims an official answer.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the International Relations demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the foreign-policy concept and distinguish the nearest doctrine, grouping, treaty or operational category. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Map India's interests, capabilities and constraints against the partner's agency at bilateral, regional and systemic levels. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the exact treaty, institution, corridor, agreement, operation or summit with membership, mandate, date and status. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace strategic objective, selected instrument, implementing actors, resources, bottleneck, output and outcome. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed

status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use named India-centric diplomatic, security, trade, connectivity, diaspora or development evidence without event-listing. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test dependence, escalation, legitimacy, domestic distribution, financing, partner divergence, alternatives and residual risk. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the International Relations demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 Q9 (direct; local paper text reproduced verbatim):** "The West is

fostering India as an alternative to reduce dependence on China's supply chain and as a strategically to counter China's political and economic dominance." Explain this statement with examples.* Structure the answer: (1) define friend-shoring/de-risking; (2) cite iCET (17 June 2024 review), clean-energy supply-chain commitments (21 September 2024) and TRUST/COMPACT (13 February 2025) as concrete examples; (3) note the risk of overstating this as "replacement" rather than diversification, and cite the 2025-26 US tariff cycle as evidence that "fostering" is conditional and reversible; (4) close with the strategic- autonomy point that India pursues this without abandoning China trade or Russia defence/energy ties (23rd Annual Summit, 4-5 December 2025).

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	78	India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation, and Indo-Pacific dialogue	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026 - ■GS1 - ■Provis ional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation, and Indo-Pacific dialogue

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	9	West fostering India as an alternative to China's supply chain	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- West fostering India as an alternative to China's supply chain

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-II	9	India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-II	20	Friction in India-US ties and India's place in US global strategy	Explain with suitable examples · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	89	India nuclear field cooperation bilateral action plan	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	GS-II	10	The USA facing an existential challenge from China	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership
- Friction in India-US ties and India's place in US global strategy
- India nuclear field cooperation bilateral action plan
- The USA facing an existential challenge from China

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 Q9 (direct; local paper text reproduced verbatim):** "The West is

fostering India as an alternative to reduce dependence on China's supply chain and as a strategically to counter China's political and economic dominance." Explain this statement with examples.* An advanced-level answer should:

1. Separate the economic (diversification opportunity) and strategic (mistrust of China) dimensions explicitly.
2. Cite iCET (17 June 2024 review), the clean-energy supply-chain commitments (21 September 2024) and TRUST/COMPACT (13 February 2025) as concrete evidence.
3. Qualify the "counter China's dominance" framing - India pursues diversification, not an anti-China alliance, and sustains simultaneous China engagement (the 24th SR round, 19 August 2025) and Russia defence-energy ties (23rd Annual Summit, 4-5 December 2025).
4. Flag the autonomy-dependence trade-off if the US-technology track deepens without reciprocal technology-sharing, and cite the 2025-26 US tariff cycle as evidence that "fostering" is conditional and reversible.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-II

- Routed question demands: 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-II	9	India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-II	20	Friction in India-US ties and India's place in US global strategy	Explain with suitable examples · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2021	GS-II	10	The USA facing an existential challenge from China	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership
- Friction in India-US ties and India's place in US global strategy
- The USA facing an existential challenge from China

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: The India-Japan contemporary global and strategic partnership, a Comment demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger with the word limit taken from the instruction block.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the India-Japan partnership is best commented upon as a non-treaty partnership that delivers security, infrastructure and technology simultaneously, which is precisely what makes it valuable to a state pursuing diversification without alliance. Named evidence and example: elevation to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014; the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting in New Delhi on 20 August 2024, which agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation; the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed in September 2020 and operational from 2021; Japan International Cooperation Agency commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail with Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation; and the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched with Australia in April 2021. Analysis: each instrument occupies a different level of the toolkit, since the two-plus-two is a political and defence consultation mechanism, the supplies agreement is an enabling instrument that extends the geographic reach of exercises and humanitarian assistance, the rail commitment converts partnership into long-term infrastructure and technology transfer, and the resilience initiative translates de-risking into a plurilateral economic instrument, so the partnership is broad precisely because no single instrument carries a treaty obligation.

Qualification: the comment must not overstate any of these, because logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production, and Japan's own security constraints and implementation pace prevent the partnership from substituting for Indian capability. Why this earns marks: it answers the Comment directive by making an evaluative judgement about the partnership's character rather than listing its milestones, and it prices each instrument at its exact evidentiary level.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 9", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the India-Japan partnership is best commented upon as a non-treaty partnership that delivers security, infrastructure and technology simultaneously, which is precisely what makes it valuable to a state pursuing diversification without alliance. Named evidence and example: elevation to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014; the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting in New Delhi on 20 August 2024, which agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation; the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed in September 2020 and operational from 2021; Japan International Cooperation Agency commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail with Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation; and the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched with Australia in April 2021. Analysis: each instrument occupies a different level of the toolkit, since the two-plus-two is a political and defence consultation mechanism, the supplies agreement is an enabling instrument that extends the geographic reach of exercises and humanitarian assistance, the rail commitment converts partnership into long-term infrastructure and technology transfer, and the resilience initiative translates de-risking into a plurilateral economic instrument, so the partnership is broad precisely because no single instrument carries a treaty obligation. Qualification: the comment must not overstate any of these, because logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production, and Japan's own security constraints and implementation pace prevent the partnership from substituting for Indian capability. Why this earns marks: it answers the Comment directive by making an evaluative judgement about the partnership's character rather than listing its milestones, and it prices each instrument at its exact evidentiary level.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the India-Japan partnership is best commented upon as a non-treaty partnership that delivers security, infrastructure and technology simultaneously, which is precisely what makes it valuable to a state pursuing diversification without alliance. Named evidence and example: elevation to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014; the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting in New Delhi on 20 August 2024, which agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation; the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed in September 2020 and operational from 2021; Japan International Cooperation Agency commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail with Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation; and the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched with Australia in April 2021. Analysis: each instrument occupies a different level of the toolkit, since the two-plus-two is a political and defence consultation mechanism, the supplies agreement is an enabling instrument that extends the geographic reach of exercises and humanitarian assistance, the rail commitment converts partnership into long-term infrastructure and technology transfer, and the resilience initiative translates de-risking into a plurilateral economic instrument, so the partnership is broad precisely because no single instrument carries a treaty obligation. Qualification: the comment must not overstate any of these, because logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production, and Japan's own security constraints and implementation pace prevent the partnership from substituting for Indian capability. Why this earns marks: it answers the Comment directive by making an evaluative judgement about the partnership's character

rather than listing its milestones, and it prices each instrument at its exact evidentiary level.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 9", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 20

Demand: Friction in India-United States ties and India's place in United States global strategy, an Explain with suitable examples demand of 15 marks and 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger with the word limit taken from the instruction block.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: friction persists inside a deepening relationship because India's place in United States global strategy is instrumental rather than allied, so convergence and coercion can operate at the same time. Named evidence and example: Tharoor's recommendation to view the relationship as a tactical partnership serving both countries' short-term interests together with his caution against hyperbole; his separate record of continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India; the enabling architecture of the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018 and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020; the 2016 Major Defence Partner designation and the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025; and the tariff sequence in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326, an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329 and was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, with a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026 and India's official description of the Russian-oil-linked action as unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025. Analysis: the enabling agreements raise interoperability, logistics and situational awareness without creating an obligation, which is exactly the arrangement a state seeking freedom of action wants, but the same absence of obligation leaves India exposed to unilateral measures that a treaty ally would contest through alliance machinery; technology-access restriction is the standing structural friction because it withholds the specific good that the partnership is supposed to supply, while Sikri's caution against enmeshing military planning while remaining heavily dependent on Russian equipment shows that friction runs in both directions. Qualification: the answer must not convert exposure into obligation, because another state's unilateral tariff or sanctions law creates secondary risk rather than a binding international-law duty on India, and it must not treat the tariff measures as settled policy, since they were executive-order-based and reversible within months. Why this earns marks: it explains a mechanism with dated, checkable examples on both the convergence and the friction side, and it names the exact legal character of each instrument.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 20", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: friction persists inside a deepening relationship because India's place in United States global strategy is instrumental rather than allied, so convergence and coercion can operate at the same time. Named evidence and example: Tharoor's recommendation to view the relationship as a tactical partnership serving both countries' short-term interests together with his caution against hyperbole; his separate record of continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India; the enabling architecture of the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018 and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020; the 2016 Major Defence Partner designation and the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025; and

the tariff sequence in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326, an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329 and was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, with a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026 and India's official description of the Russian-oil-linked action as unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025. Analysis: the enabling agreements raise interoperability, logistics and situational awareness without creating an obligation, which is exactly the arrangement a state seeking freedom of action wants, but the same absence of obligation leaves India exposed to unilateral measures that a treaty ally would contest through alliance machinery; technology-access restriction is the standing structural friction because it withholds the specific good that the partnership is supposed to supply, while Sikri's caution against enmeshing military planning while remaining heavily dependent on Russian equipment shows that friction runs in both directions. Qualification: the answer must not convert exposure into obligation, because another state's unilateral tariff or sanctions law creates secondary risk rather than a binding international-law duty on India, and it must not treat the tariff measures as settled policy, since they were executive-order-based and reversible within months. Why this earns marks: it explains a mechanism with dated, checkable examples on both the convergence and the friction side, and it names the exact legal character of each instrument.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 20 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: friction persists inside a deepening relationship because India's place in United States global strategy is instrumental rather than allied, so convergence and coercion can operate at the same time. Named evidence and example: Tharoor's recommendation to view the relationship as a tactical partnership serving both countries' short-term interests together with his caution against hyperbole; his separate record of continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India; the enabling architecture of the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018 and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020; the 2016 Major Defence Partner designation and the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025; and the tariff sequence in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326, an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329 and was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, with a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026 and India's official description of the Russian-oil-linked action as unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025. Analysis: the enabling agreements raise interoperability, logistics and situational awareness without creating an obligation, which is exactly the arrangement a state seeking freedom of action wants, but the same absence of obligation leaves India exposed to unilateral measures that a treaty ally would contest through alliance machinery; technology-access restriction is the standing structural friction because it withholds the specific good that the partnership is supposed to supply, while Sikri's caution against enmeshing military planning while remaining heavily dependent on Russian equipment shows that friction runs in both directions. Qualification: the answer must not convert exposure into obligation, because another state's unilateral tariff or sanctions law creates secondary risk rather than a binding international-law duty on India, and it must not treat the tariff measures as settled policy, since they were executive-order-based and reversible within months. Why this earns marks: it explains a mechanism with dated, checkable examples on both the convergence and the friction side, and it names the exact legal character of each instrument.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 General Studies Paper II Question 20", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 10

Demand: The United States facing an existential challenge from China, an Explain demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the challenge is best explained as structural and economic rather than merely military, because it operates through concentration of manufacturing and technology capacity, and India's relevance to it is as a diversification partner rather than as a bloc member. Named evidence and example: the Western interest in reducing concentration risk that produced friend-shoring and trusted-supply-chain policy; the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced in May 2022 with its inaugural meeting on 31 January 2023 and second review on 17 June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched by Australia, India and Japan in April 2021; and the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 as minilateral vehicles. Analysis: concentration in electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates converts an ordinary commercial dependence into a strategic vulnerability, which is why the response is expressed through technology-cooperation initiatives and plurilateral matching mechanisms rather than through tariffs alone, and why India is approached as an alternative production and technology base; the same logic explains why India accepts the opportunity through specific instruments rather than through a bloc commitment. Qualification: the explanation must not slide into asserting that India replaces China or joins an anti-China alliance, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs is a multi-year undertaking, India's own posture is de-risking rather than decoupling, and minilateral coalitions carry real coordination costs across partners with differing priorities. Why this earns marks: it explains a systemic mechanism with dated instruments, keeps India's position correctly classified, and states the scale limit that most answers omit.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 10", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the challenge is best explained as structural and economic rather than merely military, because it operates through concentration of manufacturing and technology capacity, and India's relevance to it is as a diversification partner rather than as a bloc member. Named evidence and example: the Western interest in reducing concentration risk that produced friend-shoring and trusted-supply-chain policy; the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced in May 2022 with its inaugural meeting on 31 January 2023 and second review on 17 June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched by Australia, India and Japan in April 2021; and the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 as minilateral vehicles. Analysis: concentration in electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates converts an ordinary commercial dependence into a strategic vulnerability, which is why the response is expressed through technology-cooperation initiatives and plurilateral matching mechanisms rather than through tariffs alone, and why India is approached as an alternative production and technology base; the same logic explains why India accepts the opportunity through specific instruments rather than through a bloc commitment. Qualification: the explanation must not slide into asserting that India replaces China or joins an anti-China alliance, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs is a multi-year undertaking, India's own posture is de-risking rather than decoupling, and minilateral coalitions carry real coordination costs across partners with differing priorities. Why this earns marks: it explains a systemic mechanism with dated instruments, keeps India's position correctly classified, and states the scale limit that most answers omit.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 10 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: The United States facing an existential challenge from China, an Explain demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the challenge is best explained as structural and economic rather than merely military, because it operates through concentration of manufacturing and technology capacity, and India's relevance to it is as a diversification partner rather than as a bloc member. Named evidence and example: the Western interest in reducing concentration risk that produced friend-shoring and trusted-supply-chain policy; the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced in May 2022 with its inaugural meeting on 31 January 2023 and second review on 17 June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative launched by Australia, India and Japan in April 2021; and the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 as minilateral vehicles. Analysis: concentration in electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates converts an ordinary commercial dependence into a strategic vulnerability, which is why the response is expressed through technology-cooperation initiatives and plurilateral matching mechanisms rather than through tariffs alone, and why India is approached as an alternative production and technology base; the same logic explains why India accepts the opportunity through specific instruments rather than through a bloc commitment. Qualification: the explanation must not slide into asserting that India replaces China or joins an anti-China alliance, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs is a multi-year undertaking, India's own posture is de-risking rather than decoupling, and minilateral coalitions carry real coordination costs across partners with differing priorities. Why this earns marks: it explains a systemic mechanism with dated instruments, keeps India's position correctly classified, and states the scale limit that most answers omit.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 10", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: The supplied paper text is reproduced exactly as printed, including its apparent defects: "The West is fostering India as an alternative to reduce dependence on China's supply chain and as a strategically to counter China's political and economic dominance." Explain this statement with examples, an Explain demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner with its printed defects retained rather than silently corrected. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the statement is accurate as a description of Western intent but must be qualified twice, because fostering means diversification rather than replacement and because the fostering itself proved conditional and reversible. Named evidence and example: the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its review of 17

June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; TRUST and COMPACT announced on 13 February 2025 with Mission 500 and the launch of bilateral trade-agreement negotiations; the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed on 31 October 2025; and, as counter-evidence, the twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, the additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, and the separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026. Analysis: each named instrument is a real, dated expression of Western diversification interest and together they show technology, energy and defence-industrial channels opening at once, which is what fostering means in practice; yet the same partner applied coercive trade measures during the same window, so the fostering is transactional and conditional, and India's simultaneous continuation of the China dialogue through the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round of 19 August 2025 and of the Russia track through the twenty-third Annual Summit of 4 and 5 December 2025 demonstrates that India accepts the opportunity without adopting an anti-China alliance posture. Qualification: the answer must reject the replacement reading, since China remains a major trading partner even as alternative capacity develops elsewhere, must not describe any of the named instruments as a treaty or alliance, and must treat the tariff measures as dated executive actions rather than a standing rate. Why this earns marks: it explains the statement with concrete dated examples, supplies the strongest available counter-evidence instead of accepting the premise uncritically, and closes on the strategic-autonomy point that the three tracks ran simultaneously.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 9", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the statement is accurate as a description of Western intent but must be qualified twice, because fostering means diversification rather than replacement and because the fostering itself proved conditional and reversible. Named evidence and example: the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its review of 17 June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; TRUST and COMPACT announced on 13 February 2025 with Mission 500 and the launch of bilateral trade-agreement negotiations; the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed on 31 October 2025; and, as counter-evidence, the twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, the additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, and the separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026. Analysis: each named instrument is a real, dated expression of Western diversification interest and together they show technology, energy and defence-industrial channels opening at once, which is what fostering means in practice; yet the same partner applied coercive trade measures during the same window, so the fostering is transactional and conditional, and India's simultaneous continuation of the China dialogue through the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round of 19 August 2025 and of the Russia track through the twenty-third Annual Summit of 4 and 5 December 2025 demonstrates that India accepts the opportunity without adopting an anti-China alliance posture. Qualification: the answer must reject the replacement reading, since China remains a major trading partner even as alternative capacity develops elsewhere, must not describe any of the named instruments as a treaty or alliance, and must treat the tariff measures as dated executive actions rather than a standing rate. Why this earns marks: it explains the statement with concrete dated examples, supplies the strongest available counter-evidence instead of accepting the premise uncritically, and closes on the strategic-autonomy point that the three tracks ran simultaneously.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the statement is accurate as a description of Western intent but must be qualified twice, because fostering means diversification rather than replacement and because the fostering itself proved conditional and reversible. Named evidence and example: the initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology and its review of 17 June 2024 covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments of 21 September 2024; TRUST and COMPACT announced on 13 February 2025 with Mission 500 and the launch of bilateral trade-agreement negotiations; the ten-year Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership signed on 31 October 2025; and, as counter-evidence, the twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, the additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, and the separate ten per cent Section 301 duty from 24 July 2026. Analysis: each named instrument is a real, dated expression of Western diversification interest and together they show technology, energy and defence-industrial channels opening at once, which is what fostering means in practice; yet the same partner applied coercive trade measures during the same window, so the fostering is transactional and conditional, and India's simultaneous continuation of the China dialogue through the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round of 19 August 2025 and of the Russia track through the twenty-third Annual Summit of 4 and 5 December 2025 demonstrates that India accepts the opportunity without adopting an anti-China alliance posture. Qualification: the answer must reject the replacement reading, since China remains a major trading partner even as alternative capacity develops elsewhere, must not describe any of the named instruments as a treaty or alliance, and must treat the tariff measures as dated executive actions rather than a standing rate. Why this earns marks: it explains the statement with concrete dated examples, supplies the strongest available counter-evidence instead of accepting the premise uncritically, and closes on the strategic-autonomy point that the three tracks ran simultaneously.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 General Studies Paper II Question 9", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why high trade volume between India and China coexists with enduring strategic mistrust. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Trade volume and strategic trust are separate variables because the relationship is political and strategic in origin and rests on an unresolved boundary dispute, so the answer must separate the two dimensions, add the raw-material-for-manufactured-goods asymmetry as a compounding grievance, and qualify any ranking claim as requiring current official trade data.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement.
- Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces

rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track.

- De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.
- On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.

Qualified conclusion: Trade volume and strategic trust are separate variables because the relationship is political and strategic in origin and rests on an unresolved boundary dispute, so the answer must separate the two dimensions, add the raw-material-for-manufactured-goods asymmetry as a compounding grievance, and qualify any ranking claim as requiring current official trade data.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why high trade volume between India and China coexists with enduring strategic...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Trade volume and strategic trust are separate variables because the relationship is political and strategic in origin and rests on an unresolved boundary dispute, so the answer must separate the two dimensions, add the raw-material-for-manufactured-goods asymmetry as a compounding grievance, and qualify any ranking claim as requiring current official trade data.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Sikri records India's concern over its trade deficit and the pattern of India exporting mostly raw materials and commodities while China exports mostly manufactured products, with Chinese firms suspected of dumping given China's non-market economy with opaque pricing, and he documents a specific trade deficit of over ten billion dollars from the 2007 era; the owners require that figure to be cited as historical period evidence of the underlying grievance rather than as a current number, and the analytical point is that the structural asymmetry reinforces rather than offsets strategic distrust, so the cooperative economic track does not soften the security track. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Trade volume and strategic trust are separate variables because the relationship is political and strategic in origin and rests on an unresolved boundary dispute, so the answer must separate the two dimensions, add the raw-material-for-manufactured-goods asymmetry as a compounding grievance, and qualify any ranking claim as requiring current official trade data.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why high trade volume between India and China coexists with enduring strategic...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the proposition that India's engagement with the United States is best described as a tactical partnership rather than an alliance. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The tactical-partnership framing is more accurate because every instrument in the relationship is enabling or framework in character and none creates a collective-defence obligation, so the answer must name the enabling agreements and the ten-year framework with their dates and stop short of alliance language, while conceding the unresolved technology-access friction.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India.
- Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier.
- The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment.
- The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery.

Qualified conclusion: The tactical-partnership framing is more accurate because every instrument in the relationship is enabling or framework in character and none creates a collective-defence obligation, so the answer must name the enabling agreements and the ten-year framework with their dates and stop short of alliance language, while conceding the unresolved technology-access friction.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment on the proposition that India's engagement with the United States is best described...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The tactical-partnership framing is more accurate because every instrument in the relationship is enabling or framework in character and none creates a collective-defence obligation, so the answer must name the enabling agreements and the ten-year framework with their dates and stop short of alliance language, while conceding the unresolved technology-access friction.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor notes that the United States remains a leading arms supplier to India and Sikri observes that after decades of mutual suspicion and wariness India and the United States are moving toward closer alignment, yet Tharoor expressly recommends viewing the relationship as a tactical partnership that serves both countries' short-term interests and cautions against hyperbole that would frame it as an alliance; the vocabulary rule that follows is that an answer should use tactical partnership rather than alliance, because the enabling instruments in this relationship carry no collective-defence obligation on India. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor flags continuing restrictions on the sale of United States high technology to India as friction that persists despite the political warmth, and the owners treat this as a genuine unresolved problem rather than a solved one, which qualifies any claim of full strategic convergence; the operational

consequence is that India cannot assume unconditional technology access even under a named cooperation initiative, so negotiation over specific technology categories remains ongoing and diversification remains the rational response rather than dependence on any single supplier. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Framework for the United States-India Major Defense Partnership was signed at Kuala Lumpur on 31 October 2025 as a ten-year defence framework, and the owners state expressly that a framework is not a mutual-defence treaty and that India carries no collective-defence obligation to the United States; the same discipline extends backwards through the relationship, because the United States designated India a Major Defence Partner in 2016 and that designation likewise conferred a partnership status rather than an alliance commitment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-United States enabling agreements are the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement of 2016, which enables reciprocal logistics support, the Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement of 2018, which enables secure communications, and the Basic Exchange and Cooperation Agreement of 2020, which enables exchange of geospatial information, and together they improve interoperability, logistics and situational awareness; the owners attach the limitation directly, namely that they are enabling agreements and not a collective-defence alliance or an automatic basing right, while export controls, commercial negotiation and policy volatility continue to condition actual delivery. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The tactical-partnership framing is more accurate because every instrument in the relationship is enabling or framework in character and none creates a collective-defence obligation, so the answer must name the enabling agreements and the ten-year framework with their dates and stop short of alliance language, while conceding the unresolved technology-access friction.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the proposition that India's engagement with the United States is best described...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the concrete instruments through which the West's supply-chain diversification interest in India has been expressed, and state what they do not establish. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The instruments are real, dated and cumulative but each stops at a specific evidentiary level, so the examination must run from the initiative of May 2022 through the review of 17 June 2024, the clean-energy commitments of 21 September 2024 and the branding of 13 February 2025, and close by refusing the replacement narrative in favour of diversification of dependence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale.
- The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.
- India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available.
- Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession.

Qualified conclusion: The instruments are real, dated and cumulative but each stops at a specific evidentiary level, so the examination must run from the initiative of May 2022 through the review of 17 June 2024, the clean-energy commitments of 21 September 2024 and the branding of 13 February 2025, and close by refusing the replacement narrative in favour of diversification of dependence.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the concrete instruments through which the West's supply-chain diversification...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The instruments are real, dated and cumulative but each stops at a specific evidentiary level, so the examination must run from the initiative of May 2022 through the review of 17 June 2024, the clean-energy commitments of 21 September 2024 and the branding of 13 February 2025, and close by refusing the replacement narrative in favour of diversification of dependence.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the

policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction the owners insist upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; the owners fix its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** India-United States clean-energy supply-chain commitments were announced on 21 September 2024, extending the resilience agenda from critical and emerging technology into clean-energy manufacturing inputs and announced alongside the broader technology partnership; the owners treat this as one of the concrete dated examples of Western diversification interest that a 2024-style demand expects a candidate to cite, and its evidentiary level is a bilateral commitment announcement rather than a delivered manufacturing outcome, so the claim must stop at commitment unless a separate delivery date is available. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Two India-United States initiatives were announced in the same joint leaders' statement of 13 February 2025, namely TRUST, standing for Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology, for critical-technology cooperation, and COMPACT, standing for Catalyzing Opportunities for Military Partnership, Accelerated Commerce and Technology, announced together with Mission 500, a stated goal of expanding bilateral trade, and with the launch of negotiations toward a bilateral trade agreement; the owners record the decisive precision that the official text does not state that TRUST terminated or superseded iCET, so it must be treated as successor or parallel branding and never as a documented legal succession. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The instruments are real, dated and cumulative but each stops at a specific evidentiary level, so the examination must run from the initiative of May 2022 through the review of 17 June 2024, the clean-energy commitments of 21 September 2024 and the branding of 13 February 2025, and close by refusing the replacement narrative in favour of diversification of dependence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical

distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the concrete instruments through which the West's supply-chain diversification...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine India's simultaneous engagement with the United States, China and Russia during 2024 to 2026 as a test of hedging capacity. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Simultaneity is the empirical test of hedging, so the examination must date the three tracks within a single window, price the tariff cycle as a real but reversible third-party cost, distinguish exposure from obligation, and qualify the verdict with the installed-base dependence that the hedge has not yet removed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority.
- On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement.
- An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.
- Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India.

Qualified conclusion: Simultaneity is the empirical test of hedging, so the examination must date the three tracks within a single window, price the tariff cycle as a real but reversible third-party cost, distinguish exposure from obligation, and qualify the verdict with the installed-base dependence that the hedge has not yet removed.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine India's simultaneous engagement with the United States, China and Russia during 2024...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Simultaneity is the empirical test of hedging, so the examination must date the three tracks within a single window, price the tariff cycle as a real but reversible third-party cost, distinguish exposure from obligation, and qualify the verdict with the installed-base dependence that the hedge has not yet removed.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit was held in New Delhi on 4 and 5 December 2025 during President Putin's state visit, producing a joint statement titled Russia-India: A Time-Tested Progressive Partnership, Anchored in Trust and Mutual Respect, with a Programme for Development of Strategic Areas of Economic Cooperation until 2030 among the documents adopted; the owners require that S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes be treated as separately unverified without an official figure, so the summit may be cited as continuity evidence while no delivery or volume number is asserted on its authority. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** On 21 October 2024 the Ministry of External Affairs announced an agreement on patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control leading to disengagement and a resolution of the issues that had arisen in these areas in 2020, later specified as covering Depsang and Demchok, the twenty-third Special Representatives round met in Beijing on 18 December 2024 and the twenty-fourth in New Delhi on 19 August 2025 agreeing an Expert Group on early harvest boundary delimitation, a Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination working group on border management and General-Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle sectors and providing for reopening border trade through the existing designated points of Lipulekh, Shipki La and Nathu La, the Prime Minister met President Xi at Tianjin on 31 August 2025, and the thirty-fifth Working Mechanism meeting was held in Beijing on 27 May 2026 to prepare the next Special Representatives meeting; the owners are categorical that this is a patrolling and process architecture and not a boundary settlement. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Licensed production of the Su-30MKI and the BrahMos joint venture demonstrate co-production alongside procurement, the S-400 contract of 2018 is the named high-end acquisition, and the AK-203 joint venture through Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa represents an attempt to localise production whose localisation depth, component sourcing and production milestones must be verified separately; the recorded risk is that installed-base and spares concentration creates dependence even where the overall relationship is described as complementary, and that the S-400 purchase created exposure to possible United States sanctions under another state's domestic law, which is exposure and secondary risk rather than an international-law obligation on India. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed

status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Simultaneity is the empirical test of hedging, so the examination must date the three tracks within a single window, price the tariff cycle as a real but reversible third-party cost, distinguish exposure from obligation, and qualify the verdict with the installed-base dependence that the hedge has not yet removed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine India's simultaneous engagement with the United States, China and Russia during 2024...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether India's supply-chain resilience agenda can reduce dependence without decoupling from China. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Reduction without decoupling is feasible only at multi-year scale and only where diversification partners actually deliver capacity, so the assessment must define de-risking against decoupling, evaluate the Japan and European Union pillars at their exact evidentiary levels, name the technology-access and coordination limits, and close with a graded verdict rather than a target.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner.
- The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production.
- The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains.

- Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; multilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred.

Qualified conclusion: Reduction without decoupling is feasible only at multi-year scale and only where diversification partners actually deliver capacity, so the assessment must define de-risking against decoupling, evaluate the Japan and European Union pillars at their exact evidentiary levels, name the technology-access and coordination limits, and close with a graded verdict rather than a target.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess whether India's supply-chain resilience agenda can reduce dependence without...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reduction without decoupling is feasible only at multi-year scale and only where diversification partners actually deliver capacity, so the assessment must define de-risking against decoupling, evaluate the Japan and European Union pillars at their exact evidentiary levels, name the technology-access and coordination limits, and close with a graded verdict rather than a target.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** De-risking reduces overconcentration risk in a single supplier or partner while retaining engagement, whereas decoupling implies full disengagement, and the owners record India's posture toward China consistently as de-risking and never as decoupling; the boundary that makes the distinction real is scale, because full diversification away from China-linked inputs such as electronics, active pharmaceutical ingredients and other manufactured intermediates is a multi-year undertaking rather than an immediate substitution, and the precise trade-data mechanics of that transition belong to the Economy owner. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Japan relationship was elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership in 2014, the third Foreign and Defence Ministers' two-plus-two meeting met in New Delhi on 20 August 2024 and agreed to revise the 2008 Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation, the Agreement concerning Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services was signed in September 2020 and became operational in 2021, the Japan International Cooperation Agency records cumulative commitments exceeding one trillion Japanese yen since 2017 for the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail alongside Shinkansen technology, training and station-area cooperation, and Australia, India and Japan launched the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative in April 2021 for diversification, digital tools and buyer-seller matching; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that logistics access is not a collective-defence commitment, that concessional finance and technology choice do not remove construction, localisation or delivery risk, and that a dialogue and matching mechanism does not itself establish relocated production. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The European Union-India Trade and Technology Council creates a channel for technology, green-transition and standards cooperation and widens India's technology, market and regulatory options beyond United States-China competition, and free trade agreement negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026, but the owners record that legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force; the discipline this imposes is the Master Framework's legal-status gap in its clearest form, because a concluded negotiation is neither a signed treaty nor an agreement in force, and regulatory differences plus an agreement not yet in force constrain any claim of immediate gains. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Russia's full-scale military action against Ukraine began in February 2022 and India has repeatedly called for dialogue and diplomacy, invoked sovereignty and territorial integrity, supplied humanitarian assistance and generally abstained on polarising United Nations resolutions rather than joining either bloc, with disrupted European-Russian trade redirecting discounted Russian supplies toward India in a gain qualified by sanctions exposure, payment and logistics friction and vulnerability to unilateral tariff or secondary-sanctions pressure, while Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets; minilateral balancing through the non-treaty Quad and I2U2 supplies additional non-exclusive diversification channels at the cost of coordination across partners with differing priorities, and on ownership the audited ledgers route four Mains demands to this owner, namely 2019 General Studies Paper II questions 9 and 20, 2021 General Studies Paper II question 10 and 2024 General Studies Paper II question 9, together with two objective demands, namely 2019 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 89 on India's nuclear-field cooperation bilateral action plan and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 78 on India-Germany bilateral visit outcomes, cooperation and Indo-Pacific dialogue, for which no option or answer is recorded or inferred. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reduction without decoupling is feasible only at multi-year scale and only where diversification partners actually deliver capacity, so the assessment must define de-risking against decoupling, evaluate the Japan and European Union pillars at their exact evidentiary levels, name the technology-access and coordination limits, and close with a graded verdict rather than a target.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess whether India's supply-chain resilience agenda can reduce dependence without...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess India's three-track major-power engagement as a single strategic design rather than three unrelated bilateral policies. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The three tracks form one design because each is routed to a different interest and none is allowed to become exclusive, so the assessment must state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia relationships, evidence each with dated instruments at their exact levels, acknowledge the autonomy-dependence trade-off if any single track deepens disproportionately, and relink the conclusion to strategic autonomy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12.
- In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement.
- Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks.
- An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy.

Qualified conclusion: The three tracks form one design because each is routed to a different interest and none is allowed to become exclusive, so the assessment must state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia relationships, evidence each with dated instruments at their exact levels, acknowledge the autonomy-dependence trade-off if any single track deepens disproportionately, and relink the conclusion to strategic autonomy.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess India's three-track major-power engagement as a single strategic design rather than...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The three tracks form one design because each is routed to a different interest and none is allowed to become exclusive, so the assessment must state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia relationships, evidence each with dated instruments at their exact levels, acknowledge the

autonomy-dependence trade-off if any single track deepens disproportionately, and relink the conclusion to strategic autonomy.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** This topic owns India's relationships with the United States, China, Russia, the European Union and Japan together with the supply-chain resilience and critical-and-emerging-technology agenda, and its distinctive feature is that it carries the heaviest verified Mains load in the folder, with four General Studies Paper II demands routed to it from 2019, 2021 and 2024 alongside two objective demands from 2019 and 2026; the tariff schedules, balance of payments and trade-deficit mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the institutional profiles of the Quad and I2U2 belong to topic 10, globalisation and de-risking as a systemic trend belong to topic 11, and China's role in Security Council reform belongs to topic 12. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** In Sikri's book-period assessment China is India's largest trading partner although the economic relationship is not without its problems, while at the same time India's security concerns and the competition for influence in Asia will ensure some degree of enduring mistrust and suspicion, because the relationship is essentially a political and strategic one arising out of the fact that India and China are neighbours with an unresolved boundary dispute; the examinable discipline is twofold, namely that trade volume is never evidence of strategic trust, and that any present-day ranking claim requires current official trade data rather than a book-period statement. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Sikri grounds the India-Russia relationship in the observation that India is an energy-deficient country and Russia an energy-surplus one, and records that Russia remains the only foreign military supplier from whom India is able to procure high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere, including nuclear-powered submarines; the owners instruct that complementarity is the correct word for the overall relationship while the narrower installed-base and spares dependence must be named precisely, because energy complementarity and equipment dependence are different claims that carry different risks. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** An India-specific reciprocal tariff of twenty-five per cent took effect on 7 August 2025 under Executive Order 14326 and an additional twenty-five per cent Russian-oil-linked duty took effect on 27 August 2025 under Executive Order 14329, the additional duty was removed from 7 February 2026 under Executive Order 14384, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act additional duties including the reciprocal duty were ended by Executive Order 14389 in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods applied from 24 July 2026, while India officially called the Russian-oil-linked action unjustified and unreasonable on 4 and 6 August 2025; the owners record this as the clearest available evidence that friend-shoring partnership and coercive trade measures can run simultaneously from the same partner, and require these measures to be cited as dated, reversible executive actions rather than as a standing rate or settled trade policy. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The three tracks form one design because each is routed to a different interest and none is allowed to become exclusive, so the assessment must state the structural difference between the China, United

States and Russia relationships, evidence each with dated instruments at their exact levels, acknowledge the autonomy-dependence trade-off if any single track deepens disproportionately, and relink the conclusion to strategic autonomy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess India's three-track major-power engagement as a single strategic design rather than...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.